



2026-2027

Global Impact Academy

AP Computer Science Principles - Game On · GA 11.01900

GIA Technology Variance Agency · Computer Science & Game Design Division · Game Design Pathway, Year 2

Global Impact Academy exists to cultivate a forward-thinking and community-driven (local, national, and global) learning environment where students develop a passion for STEM learning and its real-world applications. Global Impact Academy scholars will be productive, positive influencers of tomorrow, developing innovative solutions to the world's problems.

CONTACT INFORMATION

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School Phone: 470-254-3900

ABOUT YOUR INSTRUCTOR

Hi, I'm Ms. T. Jones - an engineer turned educator, now in my 7th year of teaching. Before the classroom, I spent 12 years in the food industry in production and maintenance roles, and I bring that same real-world, problem-solving mindset to everything we do. My credentials include a B.S. in Biological and Agricultural Systems Engineering, a Master of Engineering in Systems Engineering, an Associate of Arts in Culinary Arts, a Post-Baccalaureate in Education, a Graduate Certificate in Cybersecurity, and an FCC Amateur Radio License (Technician Class) - and I am STEM and Gifted endorsed. Outside of school, I love traveling, concerts, and cooking. A few of my favorite things - if you ever care to send a little encouragement - are Arden's Garden, Starbucks, and Chick-fil-A, plus everyday helps like gas and grocery gift cards. I look forward to partnering with you this year - please reach out anytime!

COURSE DESCRIPTION & OBJECTIVES

AP Computer Science Principles - Game On teaches the full College Board AP Computer Science Principles course through game development in Unity and C#, using Urban Arts' College Board-endorsed "Game On" curriculum. Scholars join Game Grid Studios as junior developers on Project GREENLIGHT, building a real game for our client - the Riverbend Public Library - that ships to itch.io, powers the AP CSP Create Performance Task, and prepares them for the AP Exam in May. Along the way they learn programming, algorithms, data and its impact, the Internet, and the ethics of computing. The course aligns to the College Board AP CSP Course and Exam Description (CED) and the Georgia standards for the Game Design pathway.

By the end of this course, students will be able to:

- Design, develop, test, and debug programs in C# within the Unity game engine using variables, conditionals, loops, lists, and procedures.
- Apply algorithms and abstraction to build, document, and refine working game mechanics.
- Collect, organize, analyze, and use data - including playtest telemetry - to draw conclusions and improve a program.
- Explain how computing systems, the Internet, and networks function and enable innovation.
- Analyze the beneficial and harmful effects of computing, including bias, privacy, security, and the digital divide.
- Plan, create, and submit the AP CSP Create Performance Task and prepare for the end-of-course AP Exam.
- Collaborate effectively and communicate clearly about computing as a member of a development studio.

STANDARDS OF LEARNING

AP Computer Science Principles Course Framework - The Five Big Ideas

AP CSP is built on five Big Ideas and six computational thinking practices:

- Big Idea 1 - Creative Development (CRD): collaboration, program design, and the iterative development process.

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- Big Idea 2 - Data (DAT): binary, data compression, and extracting information from data.
- Big Idea 3 - Algorithms & Programming (AAP): variables, control structures, lists, procedures, and algorithmic efficiency.
- Big Idea 4 - Computer Systems & Networks (CSN): the Internet, fault tolerance, and parallel & distributed computing.
- Big Idea 5 - Impact of Computing (IOC): beneficial and harmful effects, the digital divide, bias, privacy, and security.

Computational Thinking Practices:

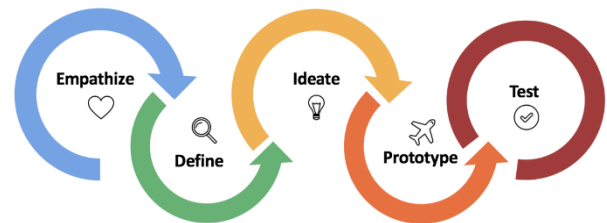
- Practice 1 - Computational Solution Design
- Practice 2 - Algorithms & Program Development
- Practice 3 - Abstraction in Program Development
- Practice 4 - Code Analysis
- Practice 5 - Computing Innovations
- Practice 6 - Responsible Computing

"Note to Parents and Guardians: In AP Computer Science Principles college-level texts may be utilized that may contain sensitive or controversial subject matter intended to support the development of specific AP objectives or skills and to promote thoughtful dialogue and deeper engagement regarding relevant topics, themes, or concepts. In recognition of your role in your student's education, you are entitled to review these materials and may request an alternative text for your student if you choose."

Student AP Computer Science Principles Classroom Resources

- ☐ AP Daily Videos
- ☐ Topic Questions
- ☐ Progress Checks
- ☐ Unit Guides
- ☐ AP Portfolios (if applicable)

DESIGN THINKING PROCESS



The design thinking process is embedded in GIA's learning experiences.

TEXTBOOK & MATERIALS

Primary teaching tools are the College Board AP CSP Course and Exam Description (CED) and AP Classroom, paired with Urban Arts' College Board-endorsed "Game On" curriculum. Scholars build in Unity (2D) with Unity Hub and write C# in Visual Studio Code; they also use PiskelApp (sprite art), BandLab (audio), GitHub (version control), itch.io (publishing), Tuva Labs (data analysis), and Canvas.

Required student materials: a glossary/composition notebook, headphones or earbuds, a pocket/prong folder for handouts, a USB flash drive, a charged district device, and business/business-casual attire for professional presentations and FBLA events.

AP Classroom is an essential component of this course and will be used regularly to support student learning and preparation for the AP Computer Science Principles Exam. Throughout the year, students will engage with AP Classroom resources, including topic questions, progress checks, practice assessments, instructional videos, and personalized feedback. These tools will help students monitor their understanding of course content, identify areas for growth, and develop the skills necessary for success on the AP Computer Science Principles Exam. Students are expected to complete assigned AP Classroom activities by designated deadlines and use the platform as a resource for independent review and exam preparation. Consistent participation in AP Classroom activities will provide valuable opportunities to strengthen content knowledge, build confidence, and improve overall performance in the course. Because AP CSP is assessed through both the

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end-of-course multiple-choice Exam and the Create Performance Task, AP Classroom is also used to model successful Create Task strategies and scoring criteria.

ORGANIZATION REQUIREMENTS	SUPPLIES
Students will be required to keep their class files and assignments organized as follows: ○ OneDrive: Create a folder and organize content by Unit ○ Notebook/Binder: Maintain a notebook of course content and AP Classroom video notes. ○ Handouts: Handouts will be kept in a pocket/prong folder to refer back to throughout the school year.	• Glossary/composition notebook • Headphones or earbuds • Charged district device • Pocket/prong folder for handouts • A USB flash drive • Business/Business-casual attire for professional presentations, FBLA events, and dress-up days.

ASSIGNMENTS & EVALUATION

Throughout this course, scholars will receive grades in the following categories and weights:

- **Majors 55%**
- **Minors 35%**
- **Practice 10%**
- **Classwork 0%**

During the first semester, students may be scored on a scale to support their development in AP Computer Science Principles. During 2nd semester, AP rubrics and scores will be enforced to prepare students for the AP exam and projects.

Department Grading Criteria: Types of Assignments Graded in Each Category	
Majors	Major projects & summative assessments: each unit's scenario-phase build (Major 1) and the unit test or cumulative semester final (Major 2), plus the AP Create Performance Task.
Minors	Project checkpoints (M1, M2) and the cumulative Vocabulary Quiz (M3) each unit.
Practices	Practice tasks (P1–P3) that build toward the Minor assessments.
Classwork	Daily Briefings (Do Now + Word/Acronym of the Day + Exit Ticket): formative, ungraded (0%), and non-negotiable.

*These assignments are meant to 1) help the student gain mastery of AP CSP objectives and skills and 2) help the teacher understand where the scholar still needs support or enrichment.

Grading Practices

LATE/MISSING & MAKE-UP WORK POLICY [Please refer to Board Policy](#)

Grading Absent Work:

- If a student misses an assignment due to being absent, they will be given *the number of days equal to their absence to submit their work*. If student turns in absent work by designated days equal to their absence, they are eligible to receive full credit.
- If a student fails to submit work after days allotted for absence, the same point deduction policy will apply as the one below for “student present but fails to turn in work.”

Student present but fails to turn in work:

1. **Assignment Deadlines**
 - All **minor and practice assignments** are due **one week** after the date they are assigned.
 - **Major assignments** (e.g., assessments or projects) may have varying due dates, which will be clearly communicated at the time of assignment.
2. **Late Work Procedure**
 - Teacher may begin deducting points from late/missing assignments, assessments or tasks (maximum 25% deduction) to the overall final score. In other words, if the students submits an assignment, assessment, or task late and score 75%, the final score will reflect a 50%.

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3. Non-Submission

- If the assignment is **never submitted**, a **zero** will remain in the gradebook.

4. Accommodations and Modifications

- Students with documented accommodations or modifications will have their needs met in accordance with their individualized learning plans.

Major Assessment Recovery:

- If a student scores below 75% on a major assessment, they will be given one retake opportunity to replace the grade. Before recovery is offered, the student must complete any missing work and/or attend tutoring services for reteaching and relearning. The highest grade that can be earned on the retake is 75%.

[Grading Policy Communication for Parents](#)

[Grading Policy Communication for Students](#)

EXTRA CREDIT POLICY

There is no formal chance for extra credit in this class. Scholars are encouraged to meet with their teacher to determine which assignment(s) they can revisit to regain credit.

ACADEMIC SUPPORTS

Here are some academic supports that may help your student be successful in this course:

Support is available through Thursday tutorial (4:00–5:00 PM), Friday enrichment and remediation, AP Classroom (AP Daily videos, topic questions, and progress checks), the Urban Arts “Game On” lessons in Canvas, and small-group reteaching. Students and families can find all assignments, resources, and links in Canvas.

AP COURSE ATTENDANCE

Success in AP Computer Science Principles is closely tied to consistent attendance. AP courses are designed to cover college-level content at an accelerated pace, making each class session essential for mastering course concepts, participating in discussions, engaging in collaborative learning activities, and preparing for the AP Computer Science Principles Exam.

Because instruction builds upon previously taught skills and knowledge, excessive absences can significantly impact academic performance and limit a student's ability to keep pace with course expectations. Students are expected to attend class regularly, arrive on time, and take responsibility for obtaining and completing any missed assignments due to an absence. Consistent attendance is one of the strongest predictors of success in this course and on the AP Computer Science Principles Exam.

Commitment to Learning Beyond the Classroom

AP Computer Science Principles requires a significant commitment to learning both inside and outside of the classroom. Due to the depth and pace of the curriculum, students should expect to complete regular reading, writing, studying, and independent practice beyond scheduled class time.

Success in this course depends on strong self-motivation, effective time management, and a willingness to engage with challenging material on a consistent basis. Students are encouraged to take initiative, seek assistance when needed, and approach their learning with perseverance and academic discipline. Those who demonstrate personal responsibility and a strong work ethic are best positioned to succeed in the course and on the AP Computer Science Principles Exam.

Student Academic Habits Rubric [GIA Grading Rubric for Students Non-Academic Soft Skills.docx](#)

Non-academic skills will be reported in a separate section from academic performance. Feedback will be given to students and parents/guardians every 9 weeks on the progress report/report card.

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COURSE RESOURCES AND ABSENCES

Below you can review the unit themes/topics that will be covered throughout the year. The course is comprised of six units of study (Units 0–5) that build the computing knowledge and skills laid out in the College Board AP CSP Course Framework and the Georgia standards for the Game Design pathway.

For **student absences**, students can find all class assignments and resources in CANVAS. Absent students making up any missing work will follow the **late work policy** outlined above. Please note that the sooner the student completes any missing work, the better their overall mastery and performance on class material and concepts.

Units	Semester 1	Unit Dates (tentative)
0	Launch & Foundations - studio induction, accounts, routines	Aug 3–8
1	Creative Development & Unity Foundations	Aug 10 – Sep 18
2	Algorithms, Data & Game Mechanics	Sep 19 – Nov 6
3	Abstraction, Programming & Level Design (+ S1 Finals)	Nov 9 – Dec 12
Semester 2		
4	Data Analysis, Impact & Create Task - Protected Window	Jan 5 – Apr 4
5	AP Exam Prep, Portfolio & Game Design Showcase	Apr 12 – May 27

Grade Scale

Grade	Grade Points	100-Point Scale
A	4.0	90-100
B	3.0	80-89
C	2.0	70-79
F	0.0	<=69

Fulton County Grading Policies

You may view all county policies on grading here:

[FCS Grading Policy](#)



Grading Expectations during 4.5-week, 9-week, 13.5-week and 18 week.

Minimum Grading Period-Weeks	Number of Majors	Number of Minors	Number of Practices
Up to 4 weeks	Actively Administering and Grading Assignments		
Grades are posted by the 4.5-week	1 major summative	1 minor formative	1 practice assignment
5-week to 8.5-week	Actively Administering and Grading Assignments		
Grades are posted by the 9-week	2 majors summative	3 minors formative	3 practices assignment
9.5-week to 13-week	Actively Administering and Grading Assignments		
Grades are posted by the 13.5-week	3 majors summative	4 minors formative	4 practices assignment
14-week to 17-week	Actively Administering and Grading Assignments		
Grades are posted by the 18-week	4 majors summative	6 minors formative	6 practices assignment
Maximum Grading Period-Weeks	6 - 7 majors *9 majors for ELA summative	12 – 13 minors formative	12 – 13 practices Assignments

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Academic Probation [Academic Probation Information.pdf](#)

All students are on Academic monitoring during every 9-week grading period. If warranted, students will move to an Academic Warning Period for one 9-week grading period, Academic Probation Period for two 9-week grading periods, followed by an Eligibility Committee Status Review.

CELL PHONE POLICY

When students enter the classroom, cell phones will be placed in a cell phone box provided by Global Impact Academy. The box will remain locked until the end of class, when students can retrieve their phones. Technology is a helpful tool, but it can also serve as a severe distraction for students.

To help ensure that students receive the best possible education, GIA scholars are required to keep their phones in the cell phone lock box for the duration of class. The placement of the cell phone lock box and the dismissal procedures ensure that devices will remain safe and secure. Students may pick them up at the end of class.

In case of emergency, please call the front office of Global Impact Academy at **470-254-3905**, and students will be notified accordingly.

INSTRUCTOR COMMUNICATION & FEEDBACK

Communication email or phone calls will be responded to within **48** business hours (i.e., school days).

INFINITE CAMPUS

Scholars and their families can access grades and attendance records in real-time on Fulton County's Infinite Campus. The scholar's legal guardian must retrieve an access code from Student Services to log in. In-progress grades will appear in Infinite Campus so that students may see how they are performing. It is highly recommended that parents/guardians/students all keep a vigilant eye on Infinite Campus to stay on top of attendance, classwork, and class progress.

AI USE POLICY: [GIA Academic Dishonesty Procedure.pptx](#)

2026-27 School Year: Responsible AI Use Encouraged:

Students are encouraged to use AI tools responsibly in this course to assist with their learning and assignments. AI can serve as an aid to enhance understanding and interaction with course content, within the boundaries of academic integrity. All AI-generated content must be accurately cited, and students are responsible for the integrity and correctness of their submissions, including any content derived from AI tools. It is essential to critically evaluate AI outputs to ensure they meet academic standards. Unauthorized use of generative AI, without proper citation, is considered a violation of the Fulton County Schools Code of Conduct and may result in disciplinary action.

Assignment & Assessment AI Labels

Every assignment and assessment in this course is labeled with one of the following:

- **AI-Closed:** AI assistants may not be used. The work reflects your own understanding. Used for in-class labs, skills checks, tests, and quizzes.
- **AI-Open:** AI assistants are allowed as a learning tool. You disclose how you used AI and reflect on it. Used for homework, research, and learning new tools.
- **AI-Hybrid:** The task has both. Each part states whether AI is allowed. Used for projects and capstones.

For AP CSP - Game On, the following applies (aligned to the responsible-use policy above):

- ☒ AI Allowed with Citation
- ☐ AI Allowed for Brainstorming Only
- ☐ AI Not Allowed on Specific Assignments
- ☐ Teacher Approval Required

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ACADEMIC INTEGRITY GIA Academic Dishonesty Procedure.pptx

Global Impact Scholars are expected to hold themselves to the highest standard. As such, cheating will not be tolerated. Students who are caught cheating will receive a zero, marked as cheating in the gradebook, parent notification, and may also receive repercussions including loss of privileges such as extracurricular activities. If a student is caught cheating more than once, their counselor may be notified.

Examples of cheating include:

- Using AI to create something that was supposed to be done without any help or in an original manner.
- Copying or "borrowing" from another source and submitting it as one's own work.
- Seeking or accepting unauthorized assistance on tests, projects, or other assignments.
- Altering or forging grades, gradebooks, progress reports, report cards or other academic records
- Fabricating data, signatures, or resources.
- Providing or receiving test questions in advance without permission.
- Working collaboratively with other students when individual work is expected.

Each student will read and sign off on agreement not to use AI or any resource or tool as an advantage.

Updated Assessment Policies and Procedures Student Agreement.docx

AP Computer Science Principles Exam Date: Friday, May 14, 2027 (morning administration), per the College Board 2027 AP Exam schedule. The AP CSP Create Performance Task is due to the College Board by April 30, 2027.

The AP CSP Create Performance Task is due in class April 12, 2027 to allow the instructor time to review prior to official submission to College Board.

AP Computer Science Principles Exam Overview

The AP score is based on two components. (1) The Create Performance Task - a student-developed program with written responses, created during class and submitted to the College Board by April 30, 2027 - counts for 30% of the AP score. (2) The end-of-course Exam - 70 multiple-choice questions in 120 minutes on May 14, 2027 - counts for 70% of the AP score. Together they measure the five Big Ideas and six computational thinking practices.

CAREER & TECHNICAL STUDENT ORGANIZATION (CTSO) - FBLA

FBLA (Future Business Leaders of America) is the Career Technical Student Organization (CTSO) for the Digital Technology pathways at Global Impact Academy. All scholars are encouraged to join FBLA to attend conferences for professional development, network with peers and industry, and compete in technology and leadership events. Please note that FBLA membership requires annual dues, and there are additional costs for conferences, events, and field trips. Participation is optional but highly encouraged as a way to build professional skills and strengthen college and career readiness.

ACKNOWLEDGEMENT OF RECEIVING THIS SYLLABUS

After reviewing this syllabus, students will be asked to acknowledge receipt of the syllabus by submitting a digital signature on CANVAS.

Student Signature _____

Parent/Guardian Signature _____

Date _____